Kamloops Life Guide — a working tool for settlement teams

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> **What it is:** one web page that answers the two questions your counsellors hear all day — **where is it** (387 Kamloops places on a map, each showing where its information came from) and **how do I do this** (17 step-by-step cards in six languages). No account, no download, free, works on a phone, works offline.
> **What it is not:** not immigration advice, not a referral database that replaces your intake, and not a service that collects anything about your clients.

1. In a settlement session: what to open, and when

What the client says	What you open	What they walk away with
"I just arrived, where do I start?"	Find settlement services	Where to go, what to bring, and that a settlement worker is not an immigration officer
"I need a SIN / a bank account"	Get a SIN • Open a bank account	Documents needed, the office on the map, a sentence they can read out at the counter
"How do I get a health card?"	Apply for MSP and a BC Services Card	The wait period, what it does not cover, and why private coverage for the gap matters
"I'm sick and I have no doctor"	Get care without a family doctor	Where to walk in without a family doctor, whether it is open right now, 8-1-1, and when to use 911
"My licence — can I drive here?"	Exchange your driver's licence	The 90-day deadline, what can be exchanged directly
"I need to register my child" *(SWIS)*	Register a child for school	Documents, the district office, school bus information
"I lost my job" *(employment)*	Lost your job	EI, income assistance, WorkBC, and what to do in the first week
"My landlord kept my deposit"	Get your damage deposit back	The legal caps, the 15-day rule, how to apply to the RTB
"I don't have enough for food"	Not enough money for food	Food bank, free meals, hampers — and that asking is safe
"Someone treated me badly because of who I am"	Discrimination and your rights	What the law covers, the one-year limit, who to call

Also in the set: find a family doctor and get on the list, find housing safely, get legal help, file taxes, meet people and find community, care for an older parent. **17 cards, 55 steps, every step with its official source.**

2. Why it may save your team time

- **The client can keep going after the appointment.** The same card is in their language on their own phone, with the steps they have already done ticked off.
- **Print it and hand it over.** Any single card prints on one page for a client who has no data plan or no phone.
- **Fewer repeat explanations** of the same eight or ten processes, in whichever language the client reads.
- **Nothing to install or administer**, no logins to manage for staff or clients.

3. Languages, and the honest gap

- Full six-language coverage — English, French, Spanish, Chinese, Korean, Japanese — for the interface, all 17 cards, and the notes on 360 of the 387 places.
- A search works whatever language the interface is set to: someone reading English can type 超市 and still find the supermarkets. 677 everyday search terms across six languages are built in.
- **Not covered yet: Punjabi, Tagalog, Arabic, Ukrainian.** Adding a language is a translation job, not a rebuild — the structure already supports it.

4. Client safety and privacy

- No account, no name, email or phone collected, no cookies, no IP logged. One tap clears everything stored on that device — usable on a shared computer, at a shelter, or on a borrowed phone.
- Search words about suicide, family violence or assault — in any of the six languages — bring up the crisis lines immediately, including the 24-hour Indigenous line and 9-8-8.
- Cards state plainly that care is given regardless of immigration status, that what a client tells a nurse is confidential, and that applying to the Residential Tenancy Branch is a legal right.
- "Near me" keeps the client's location on their own device; it is never sent anywhere.

5. How the information is kept honest

- Every record shows its **source** — the organisation's own website (251), the Province of British Columbia's open data (80), or third-party map data marked "please call to confirm" (56) — and the month it was listed.
- **If it cannot be verified, it is not published.** 47 phone numbers that could not be matched to an official source were removed rather than left to be wrong.
- Links go to the exact page (a specific library branch, a specific store), not a home page. 22 places whose exact address is uncertain say "approximate location".
- Opening hours are structured data, so "open now" is correct on statutory holidays too. Where nobody publishes them — schools, licensed child care, city parks — the card says "hours not recorded, call ahead" instead of a number no one checked.
- Every change runs through an automated check suite before it goes live, and every place and card has a "report an issue" link.

6. What is on the map (at a glance)

Places	387	Task cards	17 (55 steps)	Languages	6
Categories	50	Areas of the city	7	Bus routes	14
Licensed child care	84	Elementary schools	25	With a phone number	329

Including settlement and government offices, health, pharmacies, food banks and free meals, shelters and outreach, legal aid, all 25 of the city's elementary schools and the licensed child care centres, libraries and community centres, banks, groceries and Asian markets, thrift stores, laundromats, transit, and Indigenous services.

Corrections and questions are welcome: Neil Xiang, neilxiang@hotmail.com • free to use and share, CC BY-NC 4.0